Northwind Ion 4 Owner's Manual (Excerpt)

Edition 2026. This excerpt covers driving, charging, battery care, cold weather, warning lights and emergencies. It applies to all markets unless a section states otherwise.

1. Driving modes

The Ion 4 has four driving modes, selected with the mode button on the centre console or on the touchscreen under Vehicle > Driving. Eco limits power and climate output to maximise range; acceleration is softer and the top speed is limited to 160 km/h (100 mph). Comfort is the default mode and balances efficiency and response. Sport gives the most direct accelerator response and firmer steering; on Performance AWD models it also stiffens the adaptive suspension. Individual lets you combine settings for steering, accelerator response, suspension and regeneration. The car always starts in the mode that was last used, except Sport, which reverts to Comfort when the car is switched off.

2. Regenerative braking and one-pedal driving

When you lift off the accelerator, the electric motor works as a generator and slows the car while recovering energy into the battery. You can choose between three regeneration levels with the paddles behind the steering wheel: Low (coasting, similar to a conventional car), Medium (default) and High. In High, the car slows down strongly enough to bring itself to a complete stop without using the brake pedal; this is called one-pedal driving and is especially efficient in city traffic. The brake lights switch on automatically whenever regenerative braking decelerates the car noticeably. Regeneration is reduced when the battery is full or very cold; a message in the instrument cluster tells you when this happens, and you should expect the car to coast more than usual. The friction brakes are blended in automatically whenever more braking force is needed than regeneration can provide, so the brake pedal always works normally.

3. Charging

3.1 Opening the charging flap

The charging flap is on the rear left wing. Press the flap when the car is unlocked, or open it from the touchscreen. The flap locks automatically while a cable is connected and charging; to remove the cable, unlock the car or press the release button on the charging cable handle.

3.2 AC charging

Connect a Type 2 cable (NACS in the United States) to the car and the charging station. The charging indicator next to the port shows the status: pulsing white means the car is preparing to charge, pulsing green means charging, solid green means charging is complete, yellow means charging is scheduled to start later, and red means a fault. If the indicator is red, disconnect the

cable, check that it is undamaged and fully inserted, and try again. If the fault persists, try a different charging station before contacting Northwind Assist.

3.3 DC fast charging

DC fast charging is fastest when the battery is warm and the state of charge is low. Navigating to a fast charger with the built-in navigation preconditions the battery automatically during the drive; you can also start preconditioning manually under Charging > Prepare battery. Charging power is highest up to about 50% and reduces gradually as the battery fills; this is normal and protects the battery. For the shortest total journey time, it is usually best to charge from around 10% to 60–80% rather than to 100%.

3.4 Scheduled charging and charge limit

Under Charging > Schedule you can set a time window, for example to charge when electricity is cheapest at night, or set a departure time so that the battery and cabin are ready when you leave. The charge limit can be set between 50% and 100%. For daily use, a limit of 80% is recommended; set 100% before long journeys and start driving soon after the battery has finished charging.

4. Battery care

The high-voltage battery is designed to last the life of the vehicle and is covered by the high-voltage battery warranty. A few habits help it keep its capacity. Avoid keeping the battery at a very high or very low state of charge for long periods: when parking the car for more than two weeks, leave it at around 50% to 60%, and if possible leave it plugged in with a charge limit of 60%; the car will then keep the battery within a healthy range and maintain the 12V battery. Frequent DC fast charging does not significantly harm the battery, because the battery management system controls temperature and charging power, but slower AC charging at home is gentler for everyday use. Extreme heat is more harmful to a battery than cold: on hot days, park in the shade where possible, or leave the car plugged in so the thermal management system can cool the battery. A displayed state of health of 100% may drop by a few percent in the first year; this is normal early capacity loss and slows down afterwards. You can see the current state of health in Vehicle > Battery > Health; an authorised retailer can perform an official battery health certificate, for example when selling the car.

5. Cold weather operation

In cold weather, a lithium-ion battery cannot deliver or accept energy as quickly as when it is warm, and heating the cabin uses energy. The Ion 4 heat pump reduces this effect, but you should still expect around 20 to 30% less range at temperatures around 0 °C (32 °F), and more at lower temperatures. To minimise the loss, set a departure time in the Northwind Connect app while the car is plugged in: the cabin and battery are then heated with energy from the grid, not from the battery. Use the seat and steering wheel heating, which are more efficient than heating the air in the whole cabin. Regenerative braking may be limited until the battery has warmed up, and DC charging will be slower unless you precondition the battery. Do not use a battery heater blanket or any third-party heating device on the battery pack. If the car will stand outside in temperatures below −25 °C (−13 °F) for several days, keep it plugged in so that the battery can protect itself.

6. Warning and indicator lights

Light	Meaning	What to do
Red battery with exclamation mark	High-voltage system fault.	Stop safely as soon as possible, switch the car off and call Northwind Assist. Do not continue driving.
Yellow battery with exclamation mark	High-voltage system needs checking; power may be reduced.	You can continue driving with care. Book a check at a retailer soon.
Turtle symbol	Power is limited, for example because the battery is very low, very cold or very hot.	Charge the battery as soon as possible. If the battery is not low, drive gently and have the car checked.
Red brake symbol	Brake fluid level low or brake system fault.	Stop safely and call Northwind Assist.
Yellow 12V battery symbol	The 12V battery is not being charged properly.	Drive to a retailer. Avoid switching the car off for long periods.
Tyre pressure symbol	Pressure loss in one or more tyres.	Check and correct tyre pressures. If the light stays on, check for a puncture.

7. 12V battery and jump starting

Like other cars, the Ion 4 has a 12V battery that powers the control units, locks and lights. It is charged automatically from the high-voltage battery while the car is switched on or charging. If the 12V battery is flat, the car cannot be unlocked or started with the key card. Open the driver's door with the emergency mechanical key hidden in the key card, then open the front storage compartment with the emergency release in the driver's footwell. The jump-start terminals are under the cover in the front compartment. The Ion 4 can receive a jump start from another vehicle or a booster pack, but it must never be used to jump start another vehicle.

8. Tyre repair kit

The Ion 4 has no spare wheel. A tyre repair kit with sealant and an electric compressor is stored under the boot floor. It can seal punctures up to 4 mm in the tread. After using the sealant, do not exceed 80 km/h (50 mph) and drive no more than 200 km (125 miles) before having the tyre replaced. Do not use the kit if the tyre sidewall is damaged; call Northwind Assist instead.

9. After an accident

> The Ion 4 uses high voltage. After an accident, switch on the hazard warning lights, switch the car off and get all occupants to a safe place. If an airbag has deployed, the high-voltage system is disconnected automatically. Never touch orange high-voltage cables or components. If you see smoke, hear hissing or popping noises, or notice an unusual smell from the underbody,

> move well away from the car and call the emergency services, and tell them it is an electric vehicle. After any accident in which the underbody was hit, have the high-voltage battery inspected by an authorised retailer before driving again, even if there is no visible damage.

10. Software updates

Software updates are installed over the air. You are notified on the touchscreen and in the app when an update is ready. Installation takes about 20 minutes and the car cannot be driven during that time; make sure the car is parked in a safe place with at least 20% charge. Release notes for each update are shown on the touchscreen under Settings > Software.